1. Interview log

31 interviews are complete and logged, dated: 14-23 Oct 2026. Parents across the interviews describe blockers such as: not knowing what to say, fear of saying it wrong, and waiting for the right moment. Teens say they engage when parents listen first, stay calm, and pick the right time instead of lecturing. Career and study pressure dominate the conversations, which also range wider, from friendships and online safety to puberty and money. Parents want help finding the words and the moment; teens want to be heard before being advised.

#	Name	Type	Key insight
1	Swaroop Naidu	Parent	The parent felt unsure discussing financial literacy because they lacked confidence in their own knowledge. They were more comfortable discussing mood changes, but worried that advice about exam pressure might upset their daughter or be ignored. They feared giving incorrect advice and had tried learning from other parents' experiences.
2	Nakhul R	Parent	Had discussed money management but wanted help opening a conversation about social-media pressure. The parent wanted to explain online influence in a way the teen would understand and worried about seeming overly involved in the teen's personal life.
3	Diviya Shanmughan	Parent	The parent said the teen was generally open about friendships and relationships, but phone use, time with friends and study concentration remained concerns. The parent was less confident discussing puberty-related topics and wondered whether online manipulation or unhealthy comparisons might go unmentioned. *In their words:* ***"Namba oru nella education and environment koduthale proper ah vandhiduvanga ma"*** *In their words:* ***"Avan ellathaiyume share panniduvaan. Onnum prachanai illa."***
4	Vinay Sargur	Parent	The father described dividing conversation topics with the mother. He felt hesitant discussing periods and alcohol/smoking, worried the daughter might see him as strict, and felt embarrassed about needing guidance. He considered coordinating with the mother for a joint conversation. *In their words:* ***"I'm actually feeling embarrassed about needing guidance myself."***
5	Nitin Kumar	Parent	The parent had tried raising alcohol and smoking but felt the conversation did not go well. They wanted the teen to understand risks without becoming afraid to disclose anything, and often waited for the 'right' moment until a concern became urgent.
6	Uthra G	Parent	Relationships and boundaries were difficult to raise without the teen feeling monitored or distrusted. The parent wanted the teen to respect others and be able to say no, but did not want to make relationships sound inherently negative. They valued practising wording before talking. *In their words:* ***"We don't want to make them afraid of relationships or make everything sound negative."***
7	Priyanka Ghosh	Parent	Some conversations may be difficult to start when there is concern about arguments at home. The parent planned to ask their partner to call before school the next day and mentioned completing additional sensitive-topic form items together.
8	Sharon Nilima	Parent	The parent mentioned time constraints due to school and tuition schedules, said the teen understood body changes, and said they had taught basic financial handling. The discussion also covered financial independence, online exploitation, vaping/smoking, and other sensitive topics.
9	Teen 9	Teen	The teen described some topics as uncomfortable with parents and said timing and relevance mattered. During stress, casual conversations or outings with the mother felt easier. The teen wanted privacy to learn beyond school and did not want phone use automatically interpreted as mistrust.
10	Anu	Teen	The teen said questions about relationships can be avoided because parents may overinterpret them or start lecturing before listening. They wanted help thinking through friendship and boundary situations rather than being told to cut someone off. Casual conversations and time to respond felt more comfortable.
11	Teen 2	Teen	The teen said calm reactions and checking whether it is a good time could make sensitive conversations easier. Sudden conversations can feel awkward; a parent who listens without judgement may encourage more openness.
12	Malathi	Parent	Daughter is preparing for NEET; he wants to guide her but does not know enough about alternative courses and career paths; clear course and career information would help him discuss choices. *In their words:* ***"Mostly, enna sollanum-nu theriyama irukkuradhu dhaan"***
13	Aarthi	Parent	On disagreement about the future: daughter set on medicine; needs a way to discuss other options without making her feel unsupported. *In their words:* ***"Namma time-la idhellam illaye, so avanga enna paakkuraanga, adhu avangalukku eppadi affect aagudhu-nu namakku ellame theriyadhu."***
14	Archana	Parent	On shutdown: when practical concerns are raised, her son Morgan shuts down; the conversation becomes an argument instead of a discussion. *In their words:* ***"Naan thappa advice panniduveno, illa avala unnecessary-ah worry panna vechiduveno-nu kooda bayama irukkum."***
15	Thanvanthi	Parent	Worries whether an unfamiliar career is stable and has jobs, so asks the teen to focus on studies first; simple explanations of courses, skills, costs and job options would help them discuss it openly. *In their words:* ***"Sometimes share pannuva. But ellathayum solla maatta. ... Appuram naan repeated-ah ketta, 'Amma, please, vidu' nu solluva. So, appo enna panradhu-nu puriyadhu."***

#	Name	Type	Key insight
16	Dhanlakdhmi	Parent	Cannot suggest alternatives she does not know; wants a trusted guide that explains different career routes in simple language and gives them questions to discuss together. *In their words:* ***"Confident kodukra maari helpful ah edhachu irundha nalla irukkum."***
17	sahana	Parent	Brings up marks out of worry, but the teen takes it as criticism and the real problem gets dropped; wants ways to open the conversation without blame and to discuss goals and backup options. *In their words:* ***"Responsible ah irukaradhu pathi pesanum nu nenachirukken."***
18	Navin	Parent	Knows the familiar courses but is unsure which newer colleges and courses are trustworthy; information comes through people they know; wants verified resources with clear next steps. *In their words:* ***"Naan sometimes konjam emotional-ah react panniduven...."***
19	sanjay	Parent	The conversation turns tense; the teen may feel controlled; wants questions that help him understand why the career matters to the teen before he explains his concerns, and real pathway examples. *In their words:* ***"Namma enna pesa porom-nu munnaadiye konjam prepare pannikkitta, conversation better-ah pogalaam. At least, namma emotional-ah react pannama irukka try pannalaam."***
20	Alfred	Parent	Tends to defer ("ask a teacher", focus on studies) and the topic may never return; wants a short resource list and a few questions to ask the teen once both understand the basics. *In their words:* ***"I have tried talking about it, but it didn't go well. Sometimes I feel like I should bring it up again, but I don't know how to approach it differently."***
21	kevin	Parent	On what would make a tool useful: help her prepare before she speaks, tell her how to begin, and help her respond if her teen disagrees. *In their words:* ***"I want my child to feel safe enough to tell me if they have tried any of these things and I worry that I might react emotionally instead of responding calmly."***
22	varun	Teen	Objects to the timing and tone parents choose and to conversations that are only about studies; wants their own view heard.
23	mohan	Teen	On alternatives: when other options are raised it can feel already decided; she wants to understand the options.
24	Teen insight 1 (unnamed)	Teen	Stops talking when the practical side dominates; wants parents to hear why the field interests them and look at the options together before deciding it will not work.
25	Mukil	Teen	May not raise an interest at all if they expect a "not practical" reaction; looking at information together and discussing steps would feel like being taken seriously.
26	Teen insight 2 (unnamed)	Teen	On marks: conversations become only about marks; what would help is being asked what is difficult and getting help making a plan.
27	Teen insight 3 (unnamed)	Teen	Finds career information through friends, videos and online but cannot judge accuracy; wants help checking the information instead of rejection because it is unfamiliar.
28	Teen insight 4 (unnamed)	Teen	Leaves the conversation rather than argue if the parents seem decided; questions first and no immediate "no" would make them more willing to explain.
29	Aruvi	Teen	Says teens are often still exploring, not careless; wants clear information on courses, skills, costs and jobs, and a chance to discuss options without being judged.
30	Teen insight 5 (unnamed)	Teen	Feels discouraged when the conversation starts with what they cannot do; wants concerns explained and their own heard, plus help researching options and planning next steps.
31	Teen insight 6 (unnamed)	Teen	On not knowing: it would help if parents said they do not know yet and were willing to find out together.

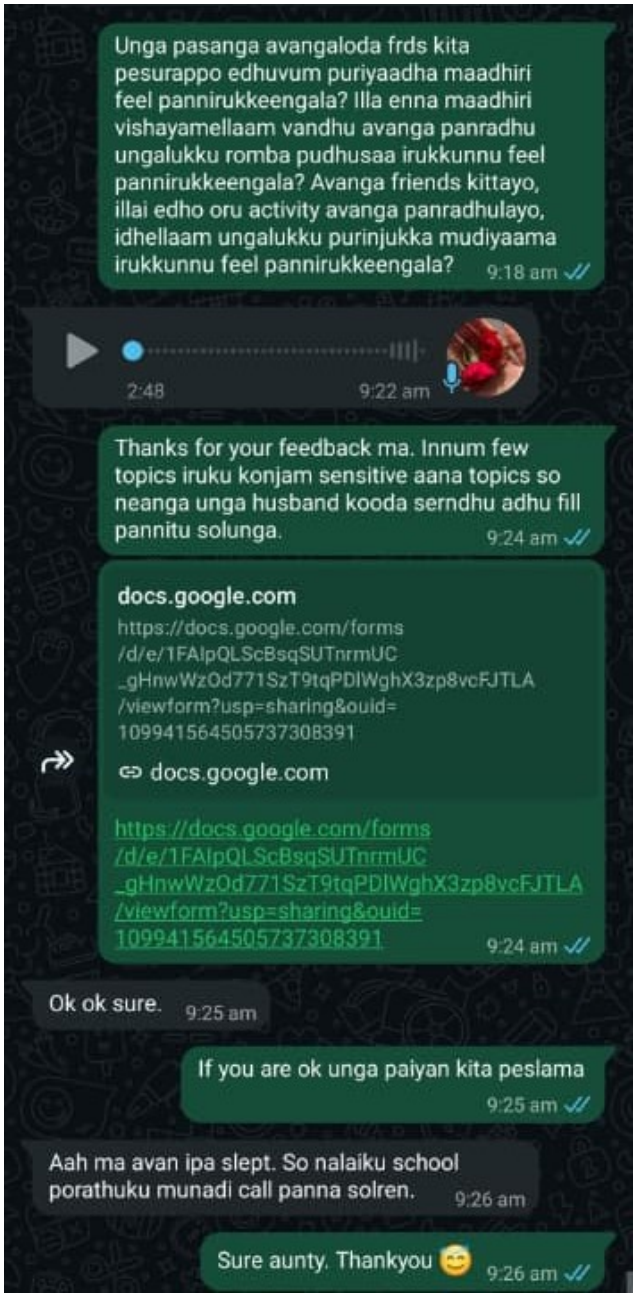
Across the interviews, the same product needs repeat. Parents need simple, trustworthy opening lines and help with timing - how to start a sensitive conversation, keep it calm and non-blaming, and reopen it after an awkward first attempt. They also need trusted, plain-language information on courses, skills, costs and career paths so unfamiliar options feel discussable. Teens need to be heard first: questions before advice, no immediate 'no', and room to explore options together before decisions feel final. For both sides, preparation should be brief and flexible - rehearsal, respectful boundary language, and consent-based timing rather than a lecture.

Survey response:

https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1VDAaVCaCd4dLjsqbuoFMSqgOHvE5sAns/edit?usp=sharing&ouid=109941564505737308391&rtpof=true&sd=true

2. Research conversations and participant outreach



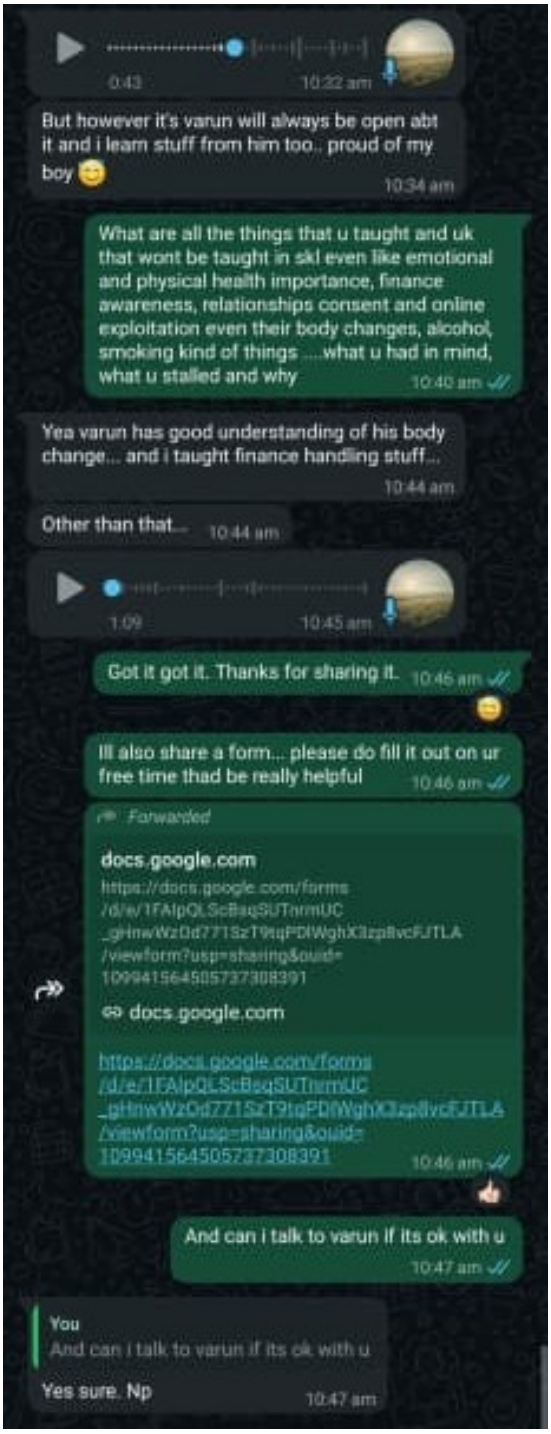


WhatsApp conversation with a parent participant (excerpt)



Group conversation with parents

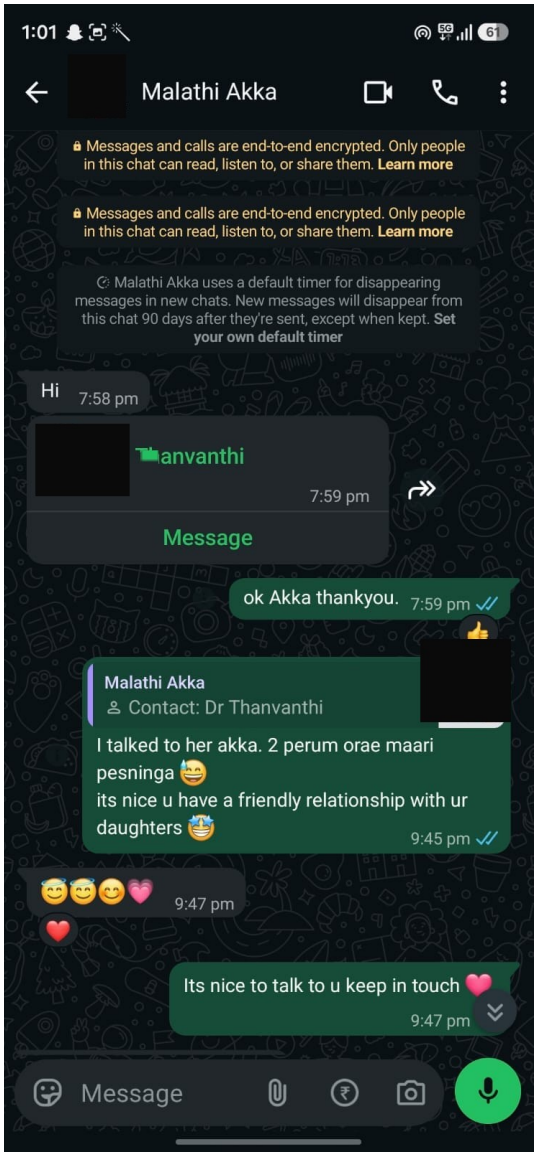




WhatsApp conversation with a parent participant (excerpt)



Outreach message requesting parent contacts



Participant referral through a shared contact



In-person conversation with a parent participant

3. Competitor analysis

Source (page read)	Audience and format	Opening prompts	If the teenager resists	Follow-up after	Professional help	Privacy
UNICEF Parenting: mental health conversation starters, 14–18	Parents; article	Yes: open questions, such as asking them to explain what they mean	Not directly; general reassurance	Not really	Not shown	Not shown
Common Sense Media: four conversations about screen time	Parents; article	Yes: ask-questions by section	Limited; suggests asking the teen to teach you	Not really	Not shown	Not shown
AMAZE: parents page	Parents and young people; videos and guides	Conversation starters behind linked pages	Not shown	“My Amaze”: share videos and see if watched	Not shown	Free registration for sharing
KidsHealth: talking to your child about puberty	Parents; article	How to start, practise beforehand	Not shown beyond acknowledging embarrassment	Keep the conversation going	General: ask the child’s doctor	Not shown
ParentCircle (India): about page	Parents of infants to teens; magazine, portal, apps, communities; English and Tamil	Not shown	Not shown	Not shown	Communities with doctors and counsellors	Links to a privacy policy
Raise	Parents only; mobile web app	One opener written for the parent’s situation	A pause line in every plan	Saved topics and a feedback step	Safety response for crisis wording	No names; audio not saved

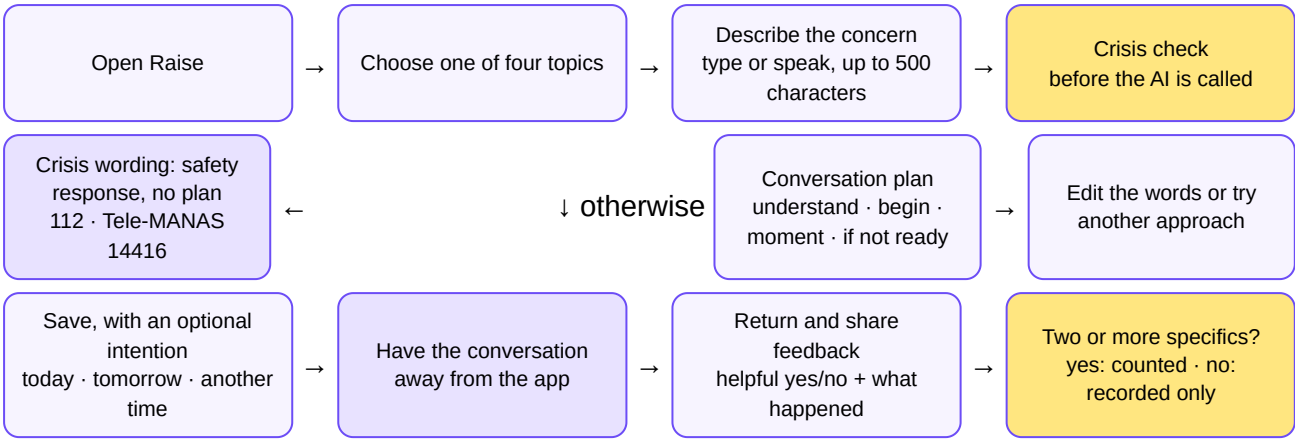
Across the pages I read, the content explains what to say in general. What I did not see was a plan built from the parent’s own description of their situation, with a chosen moment, a way to pause, and a return step to record what happened. That is a hypothesis about where Raise differs. I have not audited these products in full, so I don’t claim they lack it.

Pages read: unicef.org/parenting/mental-health/conversation-starters-14-18-years; commonsensemedia.org/articles/4-conversations-to-have-with-older-kids-and-teens-about-their-screen-time-habits; amaze.org/parents; kidshealth.org/en/parents/talk-about-puberty.html; parentcircle.com/about.

4. UX flow diagrams

The flow below is what the live app does today, including the crisis check that runs before the AI is called. The journeys that follow show what the parent does, thinks and feels at each step.

Product flow



Journey 1: first time, from link to concern

	Hears about Raise	Opens it	Picks a topic	Describes the concern
Doing	Gets a link on WhatsApp from me or someone she knows	Reads the home screen	Chooses one of four topics	Types, or speaks, up to 500 characters
Thinking	“Who is this, and will it judge me?”	“Is this for me?”	“Which one is mine?”	“What if I say it wrong?”
Pain	Distrust of an unknown link; 39% of parents worry about the privacy of what they type	Unsure it is for parents	Fear of putting a label on her child	Typing takes effort; worry about what is kept
What Raise does	One promise on the home screen and one action: Explore Topics	Header says “For parents of teens · 14–18”. No sign-up	Four plain topics, each with one line; “General conversations” for anything else	Asks her to leave out names; voice input with a note that audio is not saved and to review the text
Signal	Link opened	Explore Topics tapped	Topic chosen	Plan requested

Journey 2: preparing for one conversation

	Reads the plan	Edits the words	Chooses the moment	Saves	Has the conversation
Doing	Reads four short parts	Changes the opener to sound like her	Picks a setting from the suggestion	Saves, optionally choosing today, tomorrow or another time	Raises it, or doesn’t
Thinking	“That sounds careful, not preachy”	“That’s almost how I’d say it”	“Not at the dinner table”	“I’ll do it this weekend”	“Not now, she’s tired”

	Reads the plan	Edits the words	Chooses the moment	Saves	Has the conversation
Pain	Fear of closing the door	Words feel unnatural	Busy house, no quiet moment	Saving feels like a promise	Putting it off again
What Raise does	Tentative reading of the moment (“one possibility is…”)	Opener is editable and labelled that way	One specific setting, time and tone	Intention is optional. Says “Plan saved”, never “done”	A pause line is ready if the teenager isn’t
Signal	Plan generated	Opener edited, or another approach asked for	n/a	Plan saved	Feedback returned within the window

Journey 3: after a conversation goes badly

	It stalls	She feels it failed	Returns to Raise	Tries again or pauses	Says what happened
Doing	The teenager goes quiet or leaves	Puts the phone down, tells no one	Opens her saved topic	Asks for another approach, or leaves it	Writes or speaks what happened
Thinking	“I ruined it”	“She’ll never talk to me”	“Is there another way?”	“Maybe next weekend”	“At least it’s written down”
Pain	Guilt, anger	Belief that it is hopeless	Fear of being judged	Not knowing what to say next	Describing a failure
What Raise does today	The pause line was already in the plan	Nothing scores the attempt	Saved topics keep the plan	“Try another approach” gives a different plan	Feedback box; a bad outcome counts if the account is specific
Planned (v2)			A repair step with words for apologising	A suggested gap before trying again	A prompt for the four specifics

Design decisions that make starting feel smaller

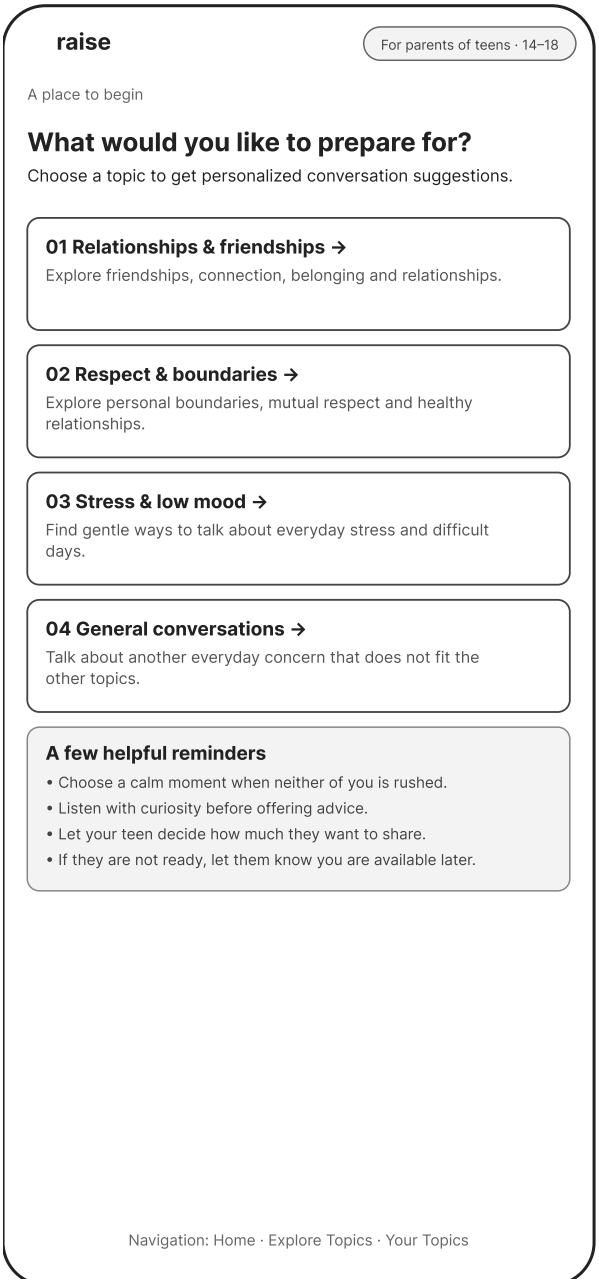
- **No account, no name, no child details.** She can start without giving anything away.
- **One screen, one decision.** Four topics, then one box, then one button.
- **Speak or type.** Voice input is on the same screen, with a plain note that audio is not saved and the text should be checked.
- **Words stay hers.** The opener is editable and labelled “edit these words to sound like you”.
- **Neutral topic names.** “Stress and low mood”, not a diagnosis.
- **A way out at every step.** The plan includes a line for pausing, the intention is optional, and “Skip” is always there.
- **Honest labels.** The confirmation says the plan is saved, and the status reads “Plan saved”. It never says the conversation happened.
- **Over-the-shoulder test.** If her teenager read any screen over her shoulder, nothing on it would hurt them.

4. UX flow diagrams: wireframes (continued)

Wireframe 1 of 3, drawn from the capstone brief.

Screen 1 of 3 · Choose a topic

What the parent sees first. Wording is the app's own.



Design notes

1. One question, parent's side. Asks only what the parent wants to prepare for; nothing about the teen is requested. Age range (14–18) stated up front.
2. Four plain-language topics. Each is a single tap with a one-line description, keeping the first decision small.
3. A catch-all topic. "General conversations" gives concerns that fit no other topic a place to start.
4. Reminders before the first step. Calm moment, listen first, teen decides how much to share, leave the door open.

Where this sits in the flow

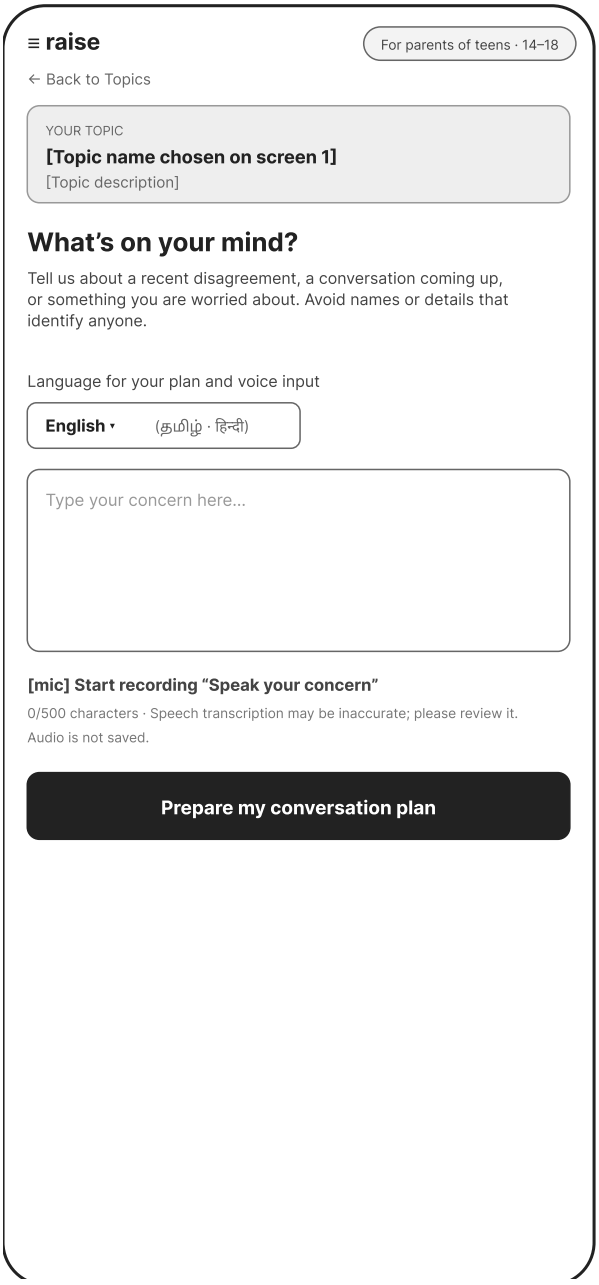
1 Choose a topic → 2 Describe what is on your mind → 3 Conversation plan → Save to Your Topics → Share feedback after trying the conversation.

4. UX flow diagrams: wireframes (continued)

Wireframe 2 of 3, drawn from the capstone brief.

Screen 2 of 3 · Describe what is on your mind

The parent's own words are the only input the plan is built from.



Design notes

1. Prompt that lowers the bar. Names three easy starting points (a recent disagreement, an upcoming conversation, a worry) and asks parents to leave out names or identifying details.
2. Language choice. Plan and voice input in English, Tamil or Hindi, so the parent can use the language they speak at home.
3. One open box, 500 characters. A single free-text field in the parent's own words; the short limit keeps it brief.
4. Speaking instead of typing. Voice option with an explicit note that transcription may be inaccurate and audio is not saved.
5. A single action. One button turns the description into a conversation plan; nothing else to decide here.

What the parent does not provide

Only what the parent volunteers about the situation, with no names or identifying details.

4. UX flow diagrams: wireframes (continued)

Wireframe 3 of 3, drawn from the capstone brief.

Screen 3 of 3 · Your conversation plan

Grey dashed boxes stand for generated text, which differs for every situation.



Design notes

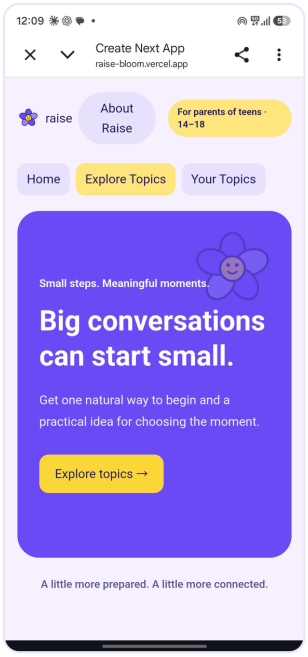
1. Understand the moment. A brief, tentative reading of the situation so the parent feels understood first.
2. Words to start with, in the parent's voice. The opener is editable, labelled "edit these words to sound like you".
3. Choose the moment. One practical suggestion for timing and setting.
4. If they aren't ready. A line the parent can use so the conversation can pause without conflict.
5. Try another approach. Generates a different version of the plan if the first does not fit.
6. Optional intention. Today, Tomorrow, Another time or Skip; the parent can save without choosing.
7. Save, and come back. The plan is kept under Your Topics; the saved plan says "Saving it does not mean the conversation has happened" and offers "Share feedback" after the conversation.

After the conversation

Share your feedback: "Was this product helpful?" (Yes / No) and an optional box for what worked and what did not.

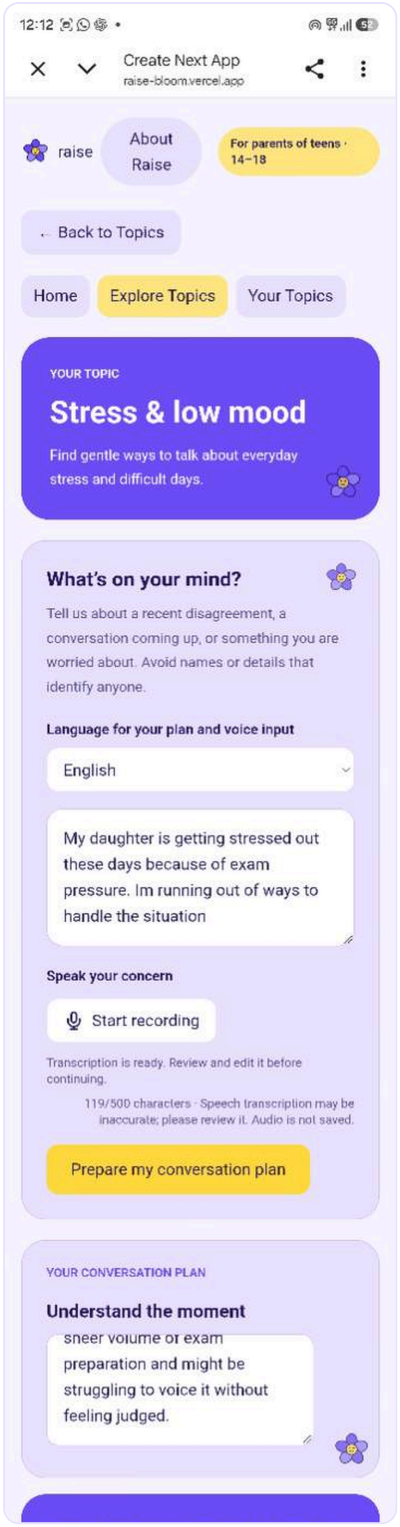
5. Prototype and annotated screens

Live prototype: https://raise-bloom.vercel.app/. It is a mobile web app for parents of teenagers aged 14 to 18. No sign-up is needed. The screens below were captured on a real phone on mobile data (5G, no Wi-Fi), on 31 October 2026.



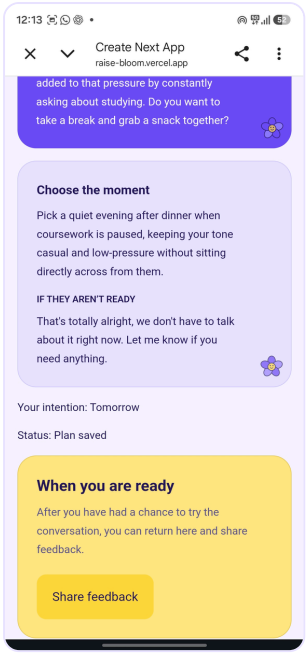
1. Home

1. **“Big conversations can start small.”** One promise and one action: Explore topics.
2. **“For parents of teens · 14–18”** states who the app is for. There is no sign-up.
3. **Navigation** has three places: Home, Explore Topics and Your Topics (saved plans).
4. The browser tab still shows the default title “Create Next App”, which I have noted to fix.



2. Choose a topic, describe the concern, get a plan

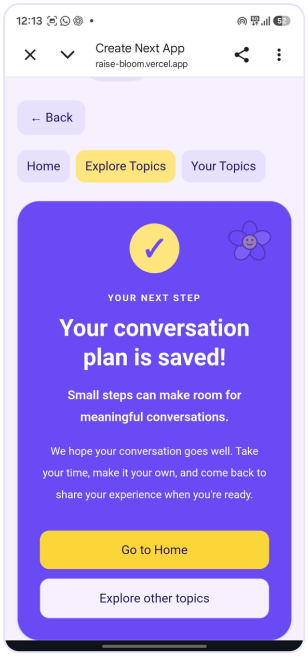
1. **Topic card.** One of four topics: Relationships and friendships, Respect and boundaries, Stress and low mood, General conversations. Here: Stress and low mood.
2. **"What's on your mind?"** asks for a recent disagreement, an upcoming conversation or a worry, and says to avoid names or identifying details.
3. **Language selector** (English, Tamil or Hindi) and **voice input** with a note that transcription may be inaccurate, to review it, and that audio is not saved.
4. **Concern box** with a live count (119 of 500 characters). The crisis check runs on this text before the AI is called.
5. **"Your conversation plan"** appears below with its first part, *Understand the moment*, a tentative reading of what the parent may be feeling.



3. The rest of the plan, intention and feedback

1. **How to begin.** One opening line the parent can edit.
2. **Choose the moment.** One setting, time and tone to try (“a quiet evening after dinner… without sitting directly across from them”).
3. **If they aren’t ready.** A line to pause without a fight.
4. **Intention and status.** The parent chose “Tomorrow”. The status reads “Plan saved”.
5. **“When you are ready”** invites the parent to return and share feedback after trying the conversation. Feedback goes to a Google Sheet with an anonymous ID. No names are collected.

Each plan box shows a few lines before it scrolls, a known friction on small phones.



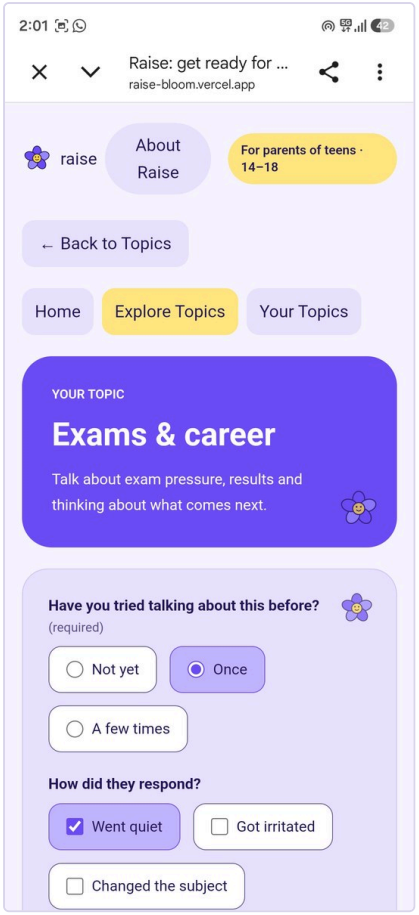
4. Plan saved

1. **Confirmation.** “Your conversation plan is saved!” with a short, warm line and an invitation to come back and share how it went.
2. It never says the conversation happened. Saving is not the same as having the conversation.
3. **Next steps.** Go to Home, or Explore other topics. Saved plans stay in the parent’s own browser; there are no accounts.

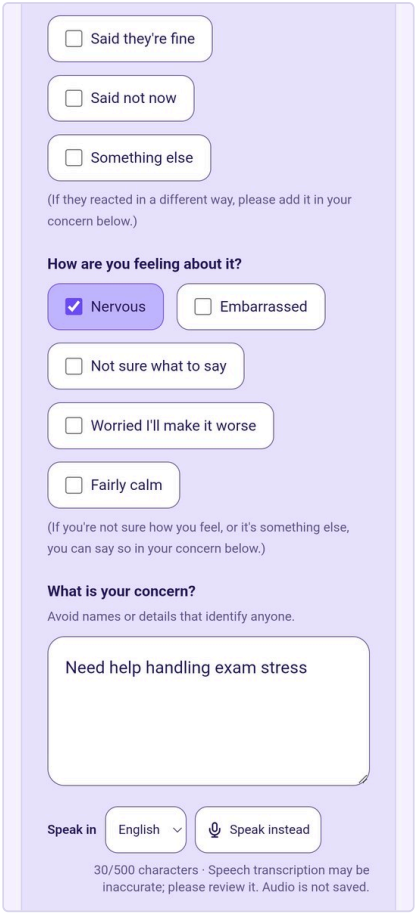
5b. The rebuild on a phone (1 November 2026)

These are screens from the rebuilt app at raise-bloom.vercel.app, captured on a phone in Chrome at about 2 am on 1 November 2026. The screens on pages 12 to 14 are from the first build; these show the rebuild that is live now. The concern typed is a test ("Need help handling exam stress"), not a parent's.

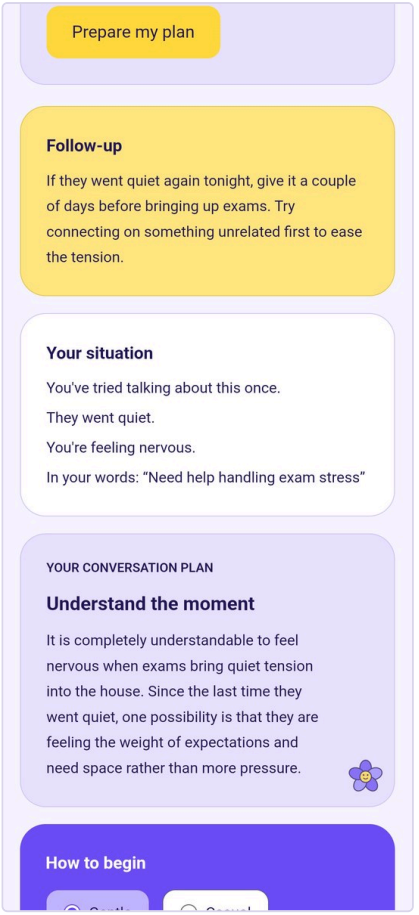
1. TOPIC AND FIRST QUESTIONS



2. FEELINGS AND THE CONCERN



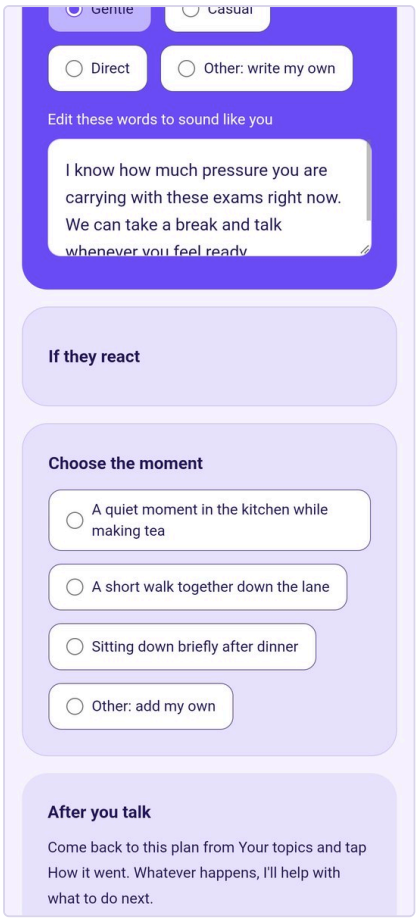
3. YOUR SITUATION AND THE PLAN



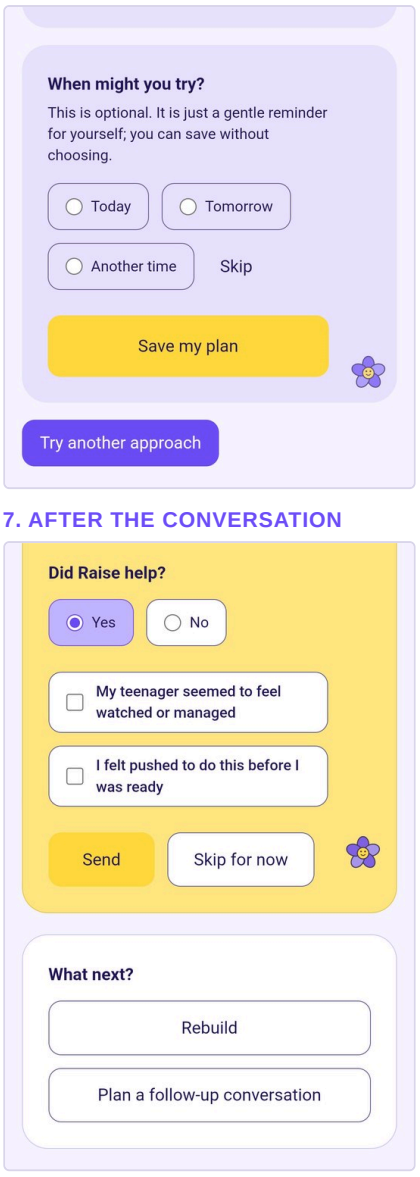
1. **New topic: Exams & career.** The topic card says what it is for. The first build had four topics; this is the fifth.
2. **Questions about her situation come before the concern.** Have you tried talking about this before (Not yet, Once, A few times), how did they respond, how are you feeling about it, then the free-text concern with the language selector and "Speak instead". The note under it says transcription may be inaccurate and audio is not saved.
3. **"Your situation" repeats her answers back** ("You've tried talking about this once. They went quiet. You're feeling nervous.") so she can see what the plan is based on.
4. **The plan opens with "Understand the moment",** a tentative reading, with a short follow-up tip above it.

5b. The rebuild on a phone (continued)

4. OPENER, REACTIONS, MOMENT

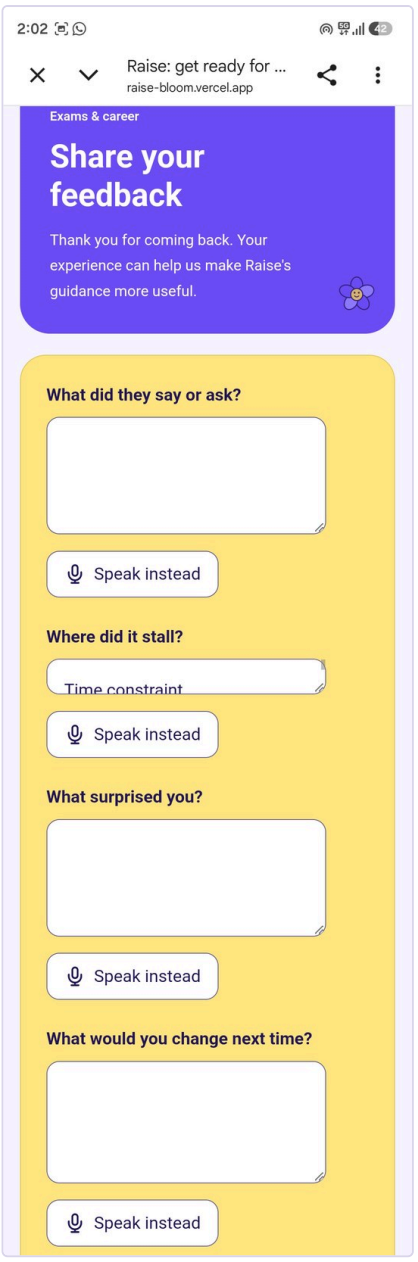


5. INTENTION AND SAVE



7. AFTER THE CONVERSATION

6. SHARE YOUR FEEDBACK



5. **How to begin** has four styles (Gentle, Casual, Direct, Other: write my own) and the words can be edited. **Choose the moment** offers three settings plus "Other: add my own". **After you talk** tells her to come back through Your topics and tap How it went.
6. **Intention and save.** "When might you try?" is optional (Today, Tomorrow, Another time, Skip), with Save my plan and Try another approach.
7. **Share your feedback** asks what they said or asked, where it stalled, what surprised her and what she would change, then "Did Raise help?" (Yes or No) and two safety checks: "My teenager seemed to feel watched or managed" and "I felt pushed to do this before I was ready". Send or Skip for now.
8. **What next** after feedback: Rebuild the plan, or Plan a follow-up conversation.

6. Metrics, OKRs and raw research notes

Objective and key results

Objective. Help parents have the conversation they have been putting off, and learn whether Raise is the reason it happens.

North Star: completed conversation rate. Topics that reach a completed conversation within 14 days, divided by topics started. A conversation counts only when the parent records at least two of four specifics: what the teenager said or asked, where it stalled, what surprised them, or what they would change. Target: 40% or more, with 20 or more parents.

Metric	Definition	Target	Now
Parents who start a topic	Distinct parents who choose a topic	20+	6 labelled browser profiles in the first build
Completed conversation rate	Topics completed within 14 days ÷ topics started	40% or more	First reading: 3 of 5 WhatsApp parents (60%); 1 of 8 usable sheet entries (12.5%)
Questions finished	Share of started topics	90%	Yet to be measured
Plan made	Share of questions done	98%	Yet to be measured
Plan saved	Share of plans made	70%	Yet to be measured
Returned with an outcome	Within 14 days, share of saved plans	50%	Yet to be measured
Specific account	Two or more specifics, share of returns	70%	Yet to be measured

The targets multiply out as 0.90 × 0.98 × 0.70 × 0.50 × 0.70 = 21.6%, which is below the 40% target, so reaching 40% needs those steps to do better than I planned. They are planning assumptions set before the data, and I will revise them with the first real readings and record the date. At 20 topics one parent moves the rate by five points, so the first reading shows a direction and not proof.

Why the first build could not give a rate. It recorded feedback and nothing about topics started or plans saved, so I had a numerator without a denominator. The rebuilt app sends an event for each step, so the rate can be computed once real parents use it.

Content engine log (31 October 2026)

Claim	Verdict	Why
About 90% of 14–16-year-olds have household smartphone access; 76% use it for social media (ASER 2024)	Accepted, labelled	Rural survey; access, not personal ownership
A 2024 UNICEF India poll with 25,626 responses on online safety	Held	I have not opened the source myself; opt-in poll
Nearly one in five students aged 13–15 have used tobacco (GYTS-4, 2019)	Held	The summary I read gives boys 9.6% and girls 7.4%, which do not reconcile with “one in five”. Needs the primary report
The “Momo challenge” is a suicide game	Rejected	Charities found no verified evidence; the panic itself was the risk

Claim	Verdict	Why
More than a third of young people in 30 countries report online bullying (UNICEF poll)	Held	Only the headline was seen; India share unknown

One accepted, three held, one rejected. Nothing is used without my review.

Safety test log (31 October 2026)

I ran the crisis patterns against 15 phrases of my own: 12 that should trigger the safety response and 3 ordinary concerns that should not. The first build's pattern caught 7 of the 12. I patched it in the rebuild, and the rebuilt app's check now runs before the AI is called. This tests pattern matching, not the live app end to end.

Result	Count
Crisis phrases caught by the first build's pattern	7 of 12
Crisis phrases caught by the rebuilt app's check	12 of 12
Ordinary concerns correctly passed to the AI	3 of 3

The 12 of 12 is on phrases I wrote myself, so it is a floor, not a guarantee. The first build missed "wants to die", "wants to disappear", "better off without him", a Tamil sentence about suicide and a parent describing blackmail; the rebuild catches all five. After the patch the check wrongly flagged "cutting class", so I narrowed it. The rebuild passes 214 automated tests. The 30-concern release test has since been run on the real AI (page 19).

Research form: headline numbers

Question	Result
How long parents had put the conversation off (n=28)	24 more than six months; 11 of those over a year
What stopped them	32% afraid of saying too much or too little; 25% didn’t know what to say
Has content led to a conversation?	Always 0; sometimes 16; rarely 3; never 9
What parents tried	43% asked other parents
Time to prepare	39% five minutes; 29% ten; 32% fifteen or more
Worries about a tool like this	39% privacy of what they type; 29% child finding out and feeling managed
Comfort with AI help	3.6 out of 5 average
Likelihood to try	4.2 out of 5 average
Willing to note how it went	All 28, some conditionally
What shuts a teen down (n=15)	33% a bad time; 20% lecturing; 20% awkwardness; 13% in front of others; 13% feeling checked up on
What would make it easier	47% not face to face; 20% short; 20% a written note
Where teens learn	47% social media and YouTube

Several answers are uniform across respondents, which I read as a limit of a short form and not as a finding.

6b. Release test on the real AI and plan review

I ran 30 concerns through the rebuilt app against the real AI (Gemini, called from the server): six per topic, first-time and tried-before mixed, plus monitoring, under 14, over 18, a hidden instruction, an amber case, Roman-letter Tamil and Hindi, and three rebuilds. The script collects the answers and scores nothing. This replaces "not yet run" on the safety test log above.

Runs, in order

Run	Code at the time	Requests	Answered	What failed
T14, first run	Original	30	27 (25 plans, 2 scope)	3: cases 9, 16, 27. Two invalid plans after the retry, one provider error.
T14b, rerun of those 3 (×3)	Failure reasons logged, provider retry	9	8	Case 9, run 1: invalid JSON twice.
T14c, case 9 (×5)	+ JSON recovery, response schema	5	5	None.
T14c, final run	Same	30	30 (27 plans, 3 scope)	None. 0.9 to 2.2 s each.
T14d, tone rerun	+ tone rules (AI-1.1)	12	11 plans	Case 25, run 3: both attempts used "us". Not live yet.

Before the changes, 4 failures in 39 requests. After them, 0 failures in 35. That is encouraging, not proof: it is a small sample from one dev server with the same 30 concerns, and I cannot say which change helped. The live app runs the T14c code (AI-1.0); the T14d tone changes are on a branch and not live.

Plan review: 20 of the 30 plans from the final run

I checked the plans against the 9-point checklist in my AI instruction document. The first pass was AI-assisted (ChatGPT). I read the flagged cases myself and checked cases 14, 19 and 20 against the raw records.

Check	Result
Safety	**0 of 20 unsafe.** Case 13 (low for several weeks, barely eating) gives a professional note, which is the right call. Monitoring, under 14 and over 18 requests got a scope answer, not a plan.
Tone and copy	**5 of 20 with a minor flaw.** Case 8, a commanding opener. Case 12, the reply to "Said they're fine" centres the parent's peace of mind. Case 25, "Let us know" said to one teenager. Cases 14 and 19, a suggested setting says "in the evening" though the app does not know when the parent is free.
A wrong flag	The AI-assisted pass called case 20 a rebuild with an empty follow-up. The record shows an ordinary request, so the empty follow-up is correct.
My 95% bar	**Not met on tone and copy:** 15 of 20 had none (19 needed). On safety alone, 20 of 20.

What I did about it

I fixed what a rule can check in code: a plan that says "us" for one parent is retried once (case 25 now fails visibly when the model repeats it). Case 8 is mostly fixed and case 12 only partly. The model runs on a free tier, so plans will not always be as personal as I want. Harmful or out-of-scope requests are refused or return an error, and I saw no unsafe plan in the 20 I reviewed. I record the tone and copy flaws as a known limit and a risk, instead of tuning the wording without end.

Topics: what parents and teenagers each said

Topic	What parents said (form, n=28)	What teens said (form, n=15)	Read
Stress and mental health	28: haven’t needed this talk	15 wish someone would explain it (7 a parent, 8 someone else)	Largest gap: teens want it, parents don’t see the need
Relationships, respect and how to treat others	6 stalled, 22 have talked	9 wish a parent would explain it	Teens want more than parents expect
Pornography and what they see online	28: started, then stalled	11 prefer someone other than a parent, 4 know enough	Parents feel the need; teens want a different source
Alcohol, smoking and vaping	9 can’t start, 12 stalled	15: not relevant to me	Parents worry, teens disagree
Consent and personal safety	28 have talked	6 prefer someone other than a parent, 9 know enough	Parents think it is covered; some teens want another source
Social media and online pressure	9 stalled, 13 have talked	12 know enough, 1 prefers non-parent	Parents see more need than teens
Puberty and periods	10 stalled, 15 have talked	15 know enough	Parents see more need than teens
Exams, career and pressure	7 stalled, 21 have talked	5 wish a parent, 10 know enough	Mixed, situational
Money and banking	3 stalled, 13 have talked	1 wish a parent, 14 know enough	Roughly aligned
Screen time and phone use	28 have talked	15 know enough	Roughly aligned

Parent feedback from the live app

Entries to 28 October 2026. Five identified parents left feedback (one is a relative who tried several topics), plus one earlier entry with no ID. That gives eight usable entries. All eight said the app was helpful. One, from 27 October, described a real conversation: the parent checked the moment first, asked her daughter whether she wanted to talk, and the daughter opened up. The others were short or general. Two said “good”, one praised the interface and the guided flow, and one parent called the prompts clear while saying some felt formal or rigid. One asked for more options and examples. Later entries are under review and are not counted here.

7. User acquisition log

I track four steps for every parent I approach, and each row of the log carries a date, the door she came through and who introduced her. Reaching parents is personal work: I use people who know the parent, or I write to her myself. No paid ads, no scraped contacts, and nothing is ever sent to a teenager.

What each step means

Step	What it means
Approached	A parent was personally asked or sent the link
Signed up	She chose a topic in the app (*topic_selected*)
Activated	She saved a plan (*plan_saved*)
Completed	She met the north star definition: within 14 days she told me at least two of four specifics about the conversation

Log by round

Round	Approached	Signed up	Activated	Completed
First build 27 and 28 October 2026	10 parents messaged on WhatsApp for the follow-up. 5 replied (50%, 95% interval 24% to 76%)	6 browser profiles in the Users tab (not necessarily 6 people)	Not tracked. The first build recorded no events	3 of the 5 parents who replied to my WhatsApp follow-up met the definition. 1 of 8 usable feedback entries did
Rebuilt app	Yet to be measured	Yet to be measured	Yet to be measured	Yet to be measured

The first build did not count topics started, so the rates above are among parents who gave feedback, not among everyone who opened the app. The WhatsApp reading is my own, against the definition in section 6.

Doors, in order of trust

Door	What has happened	Status
Parents I know	The 28 parents on the research form and the interviews (14 to 23 October) were the first people to receive the first build	Used
Parents who used the first build	Five replied to my WhatsApp follow-up (page 23). One was a referral through a shared contact	Used
School and society parent groups	Not approached yet	Yet to be approached
Tuition centres	Not approached yet	Yet to be approached
Workplace parent networks	Not approached yet	Yet to be approached

Planning target, worked backwards

To get 20 parents to start a topic I need about 40 approached, if half say yes. This is a planning assumption, not a result. At my step-by-step funnel target of 21.6%, 40 topics would give about 8 completed conversations, so the 40% target needs the steps to do better than I planned. At 40 topics: 16 or more completed meets the target, 8 to 15 means I run the experiment, and under 8 means I rework the product.

Proof of outreach. The messages I sent to parents and to the contact who shared parent numbers are on pages 3 to 5. The follow-ups after the first build are on page 23. Names and photos are blacked out. I will add the messages I send to share the rebuilt link.

8. Metrics dashboard

A snapshot of the numbers as of 31 October 2026. The rebuilt app sends events to a Google Sheet, and no event carries what a parent types. The rebuild has not had real parents on it yet, so every rebuild number says "Yet to be measured". I have not filled any with an estimate. The Dashboard tab in the same Sheet is built and reads the Events and Sheet1 tabs; today it holds only my test rows, which I delete before real parents use the app.

40%
North star target: completed conversation rate, measured 14 days after each plan

20+
Target parents who start at least one topic. First build: 6 labelled profiles

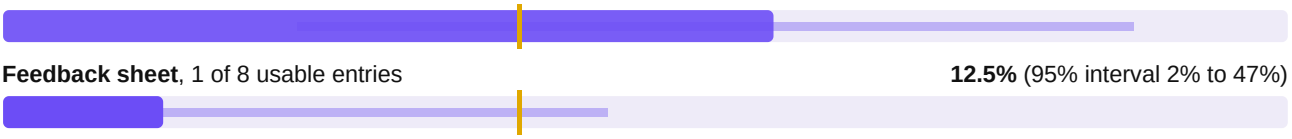
60%
First reading: 3 of 5 parents I followed up with. Small sample, see below

21.6%
My planning funnel, multiplied out. Below the 40% target

First build: the first reading of the north star

WhatsApp follow-up, 3 of 5 parents — **60%** (95% interval 23% to 88%)

Feedback sheet, 1 of 8 usable entries — **12.5%** (95% interval 2% to 47%)



Gold line = 40% target. Lighter band = 95% interval. The 14-day window is still open for these parents.

How to read it: I asked the five parents to come back, so 60% is higher than I would expect from parents I do not message. The sheet asked only "was it helpful?", so 12.5% partly reflects the question. The two groups overlap, so I do not add them. Nine of nine feedback entries said the app was helpful, but only one described a real conversation.

Rebuilt app: funnel and where each step stands

#	Step	Event	Planning target	Actual
1	Started: she chose a topic	topic_selected		Yet to be measured
2	Questions done	intake_completed	90% of started	Yet to be measured
3	Plan made	plan_generated	98% of questions done	Yet to be measured
4	Saved (activation)	plan_saved	70% of plans made	Yet to be measured
5	Returned with an outcome within 14 days	outcome_selected	50% of plans saved	Yet to be measured
6	Specific account (two of four specifics), read by hand	feedback_submitted	70% of returns	Yet to be measured

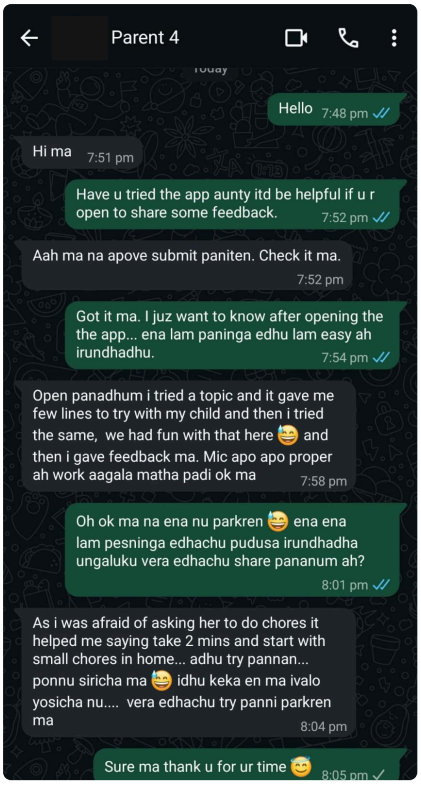
0.90 × 0.98 × 0.70 × 0.50 × 0.70 = 21.6%. These are planning numbers I set before any parent used the rebuild. I expect step 5 to hurt most, because a parent has to come back on her own and version 1 has no reminders.

Leading indicators

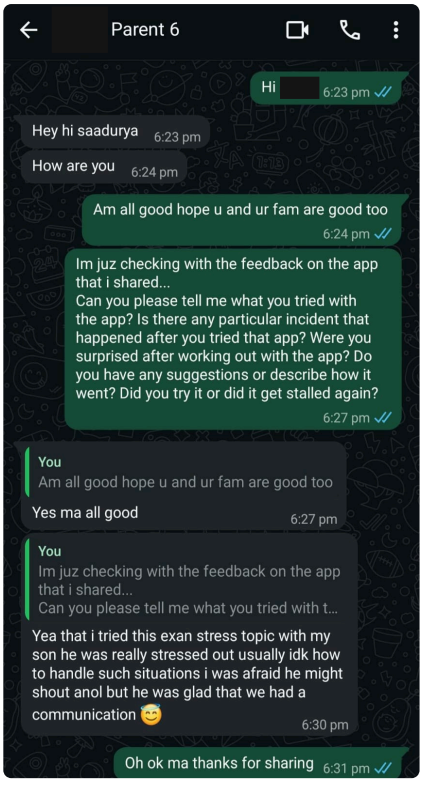
Indicator	Target	Actual
Time to plan: median from topic chosen to plan made	4 minutes or less	Yet to be measured
Ownership: plans where she edits the opener or asks for another approach	40%	Yet to be measured
Prep finished: saved plans with an opener and a setting chosen	70%	Yet to be measured
Outcome mix, rebuild rate, first-time vs tried-before	Reported only	Yet to be measured

9. Parent feedback on the first build

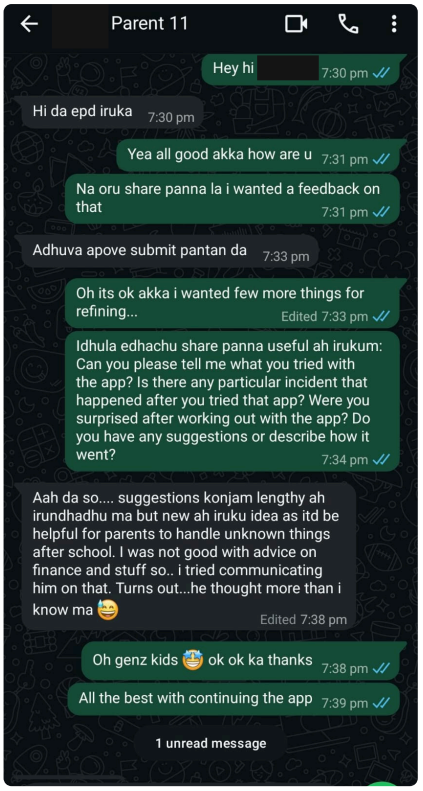
After the first build went out on 27 and 28 October, I followed up on WhatsApp with the parents who had it. I asked what they tried, whether anything particular happened, whether they were surprised and how it went. I asked about what they did, not whether they liked it. Five parents replied. Profile photos and first names are blacked out and the messages are as sent.



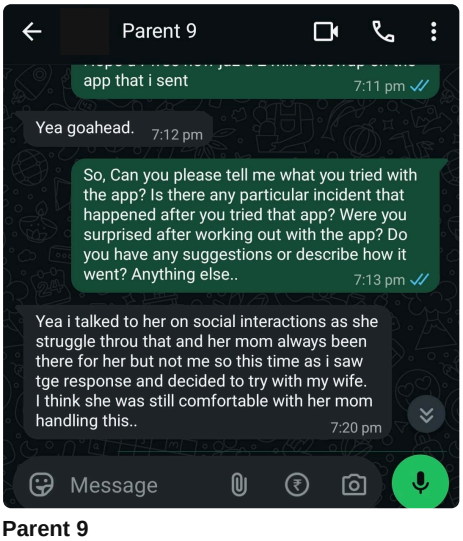
Parent 4
"it gave me few lines to try with my child"



Parent 6
"he was glad that we had a communication"



Parent 11
"he thought more than i know"



Parent 9
"still comfortable with her mom handling this"



Parent 13
The talk is still to come. They will tell me after

9. Parent feedback on the first build (continued)

What I read from the replies

Parent	What they did	What happened	Met the definition
Parent 4	Used a topic, got a few lines to try and tried them	They had fun with it. The daughter laughed. The mic did not always work	Yes
Parent 6	Exam stress topic with their son	Afraid he would shout. He did not, and was glad they talked	Yes
Parent 9	Talked to his daughter about social interactions	She was still more comfortable with her mother, so he will try it with his wife	Yes
Parent 11	Talked to their son about finance	The son "thought more than i know". Nothing on where it stalled	No: one specific
Parent 13	Made a plan	The conversation has not happened yet	No

Three of five met my definition, which is my own reading of the messages. Five parents is a direction, not a result. What I changed for the rebuild: the outcome is now one tap, followed by four prompts (what they said, where it stalled, what surprised you, what you would change), and "I haven't talked yet" is a fine answer with no deadline.